

While it's completely based on your expertise, there are other factors that should help you lock down on which type of tubing you should go for. If you're a beginner with no knowledge on custom loops, then you should straight away consider soft tubing. Not only is it easier but it's a lot safer. If you have an experienced mate giving you a helping hand in your liquid cooling project, then feel free to explore hard tubing. There's also a considerable difference in the money you'll be spending in both the tubing. While you can do away with regular household and packaged tools with soft tubing, you will definitely need to invest and buy extra tools for hard tubing. The cost of the parts also increases. Your liquid cooling build will be revolving around your tubing and fitting, so it's always best to start off planning your build with one of them. Since you will be dealing with the tubing a lot and that would be the most visible part in your build, we would recommend you to start with picking the tubing first.

Type of material

Once you're done deciding on soft or hard tubing, you should start exploring the material. Soft tubing can be found across different materials including PVC, silicone, rubber and noreprene. You'll mostly find PVC tubes in the market. The reason is it's better than the other materials for flexible tubing. Your tubing will be dealing with liquid flowing through it for prolonged periods. With time, the inner lining of the tube tends to degrade and discolour. Even PVC tubing goes through the same degradation but slowly.



Different colour tinges on PVC soft tubing

Credit: Xtremegigs